Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 13: The Story of Indian Farming

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	13 — The Story of Indian Farming
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: **+4** for each correct answer · **−1** for each wrong answer · **0** if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the classic traps: most agricultural work in rural India is done by WOMEN, not men; the Green Revolution had a MIXED record - more food, but impoverished soil, depleted groundwater, pollution and health harms; plants can grow WITHOUT soil (hydroponics); Indian farming is NOT all the same (subsistence vs commercial, rain-fed vs irrigated, kharif/rabi/zaid); and modern seeds and chemicals are not always better. Keep the cropping seasons and the monsoon months straight. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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1. 'Agriculture' is best described as:

(A) the buying and selling of goods in markets(B) the making of coins and notes
(C) the work of cultivating soil, growing crops and rearing animals
(D) the building of roads and bridges

2. The chapter calls farming the ____ of the Indian economy.

(A) backbone (B) smallest part
(C) newest invention (D) least important sector

3. Besides crops, 'agriculture' broadly also includes:

(A) banking and insurance
(B) forestry, horticulture, fisheries and beekeeping
(C) coin-minting and printing (D) road and bridge building

4. Agriculture is described as one of humankind's:

(A) most recent inventions (B) oldest occupations
(C) rarest activities (D) least useful tasks

5. Evidence of very early rice cultivation in India comes from the:

(A) Ganga Plain, in the 7th-8th millennium BCE

(B) Himalayan peaks, in modern times (C) Thar Desert, last century

(D) deep ocean floor

6. Early barley farming in the subcontinent is associated with:

(A) Hampi (B) Mehrgarh

(C) Surat (D) Imphal

7. Which ancient texts recorded India's farming wisdom?

(A) the Aryabhatiya and the Meghadutam

(B) the Prayaga Prashasti and the Hathigumpha inscription

(C) the Brihat Samhita alone (D) the Arthashastra and the Krishi-Parashara

8. The Harappans are mentioned in the chapter as people who:

(A) invented paper money (B) led the Green Revolution

(C) built India's first malls

(D) practised farming long ago in the subcontinent

9. That farming evidence spans from the 7th-8th millennium BCE to today shows that Indian agriculture is:

(A) an ancient and continuous tradition (B) a modern invention only a few decades old

(C) something India borrowed entirely from abroad

(D) practised only in ancient times and now abandoned

10. Most of India's rainfall is brought by the:

(A) monsoon winds (B) melting of glaciers

(C) rivers flowing uphill (D) ocean tides

11. The southwest monsoon brings rain mainly during:

(A) October to December (B) January to March

(C) June to September (D) all twelve months equally

12. The northeast monsoon brings rain mainly during:

(A) June to September (B) March to May

(C) the whole year evenly (D) October to December

13. Because the monsoon decides how much water crops get, a late or weak monsoon can:

(A) badly affect the harvest, especially for rain-fed farms

(B) have no effect on farming at all (C) only ever help crops grow faster

(D) permanently change India's soil types

14. The three cropping seasons of India are:

(A) spring, summer and autumn only (B) kharif, rabi and zaid

(C) alluvial, black and red (D) canal, well and drip

15. 'Kharif' crops are:

(A) winter crops grown in the cool season

(B) short summer crops between rabi and kharif

(C) crops grown without any water at all

(D) monsoon crops, sown with the southwest monsoon in the hot, rainy season

16. 'Rabi' crops are:

(A) monsoon crops sown in June with heavy rain

(B) winter crops grown in the cool season with less water and harvested in spring

(C) short summer crops grown between the seasons

(D) crops grown only in deserts

17. 'Zaid' crops are:

(A) the main monsoon crops (B) the cool-season winter crops

(C) short summer crops grown between the rabi and kharif seasons

(D) crops that take three years to grow

18. A crop sown in June with the arriving southwest monsoon is a ____ crop.

(A) kharif (B) rabi

(C) zaid (D) terrace

19. Which description matches the order kharif, then rabi, then zaid?

(A) cool winter, then short summer, then monsoon

(B) short summer, then monsoon, then winter

(C) hot rainy monsoon season, then cool winter season, then short hot summer between them

(D) all three at exactly the same time

20. 'Alluvial soil' is:

(A) dry sand blown in by desert winds (B) melted rock from a volcano

(C) ground-up plastic waste

(D) fertile soil made of silt brought by rivers from the mountains and plateaus

21. India is said to have how many major types of soil?

(A) two (B) twelve

(C) fifty-one (D) six

22. 'Humus' is:

(A) a kind of high-yielding seed

(B) dark organic matter in soil formed by decomposed plant and animal material

(C) a chemical pesticide (D) a canal that carries water

23. Humus makes soil more fertile because it:

(A) removes all water from the soil (B) turns soil into solid rock
(C) adds nutrients and helps the soil retain moisture
(D) kills every plant that grows

24. The fact that India has alluvial, black, red and other soils, suited to different crops, shows that:
(A) what grows well varies from place to place with the soil
(B) every Indian field has identical soil (C) soil type makes no difference to crops
(D) only one crop can grow anywhere in India

25. 'Rain-fed' farming depends on:
(A) canals and pumps for all its water (B) sea water pumped onto fields
(C) melted glaciers piped to farms (D) rainfall alone for water

26. 'Irrigation' is:
(A) relying only on the monsoon rains
(B) supplying water to crops by artificial means such as canals, wells, pumps or drip systems
(C) removing all water from a field (D) the natural flooding of a river

27. The main advantage of irrigated over rain-fed farming is that irrigation:
(A) makes rainfall stop completely (B) works only in the rainy season
(C) provides water even when the monsoon is weak or late
(D) removes the need for any soil

28. A 'bund' is:
(A) a high-yielding seed variety (B) a chemical fertiliser
(C) a low raised embankment that holds water in a field or keeps soil from washing away
(D) a short summer crop

29. India's many traditional water structures, like tanks and bunds, show that farmers long ago:
(A) never thought about water at all (B) relied only on modern pumps
(C) farmed only where it never rained
(D) developed clever ways to store and manage water

30. 'Crop rotation' is:
(A) growing the very same crop in a field year after year
(B) growing different crops in the same field in different seasons to keep the soil from losing specific nutrients
(C) spinning the field around to mix the soil(D) importing crops from abroad

31. Why does crop rotation help the soil?

(A) it removes all nutrients from the soil at once

(B) it turns the soil into sand

(C) different crops use and return different nutrients, so the soil is not drained of one nutrient

(D) it stops crops from ever growing again

32. Growing the same nutrient-hungry crop in a field every year, with no rotation, tends to:

(A) enrich the soil endlessly

(B) exhaust that nutrient and weaken the soil over time

(C) make the soil immortal (D) turn the field into a forest

33. Keeping soil healthy by methods like crop rotation, adding humus and preventing erosion is called soil:

(A) irrigation (B) conservation

(C) export (D) minting

34. Farmers obtain seeds in two main ways: saved traditional seeds and:

(A) varieties bought from companies (B) seeds imported only by the army

(C) seeds printed on paper (D) seeds made of metal

35. 'Saved' traditional seeds are valued because they:

(A) always give the highest possible yield(B) require heavy chemicals to grow

(C) can only be used once in history

(D) are passed down, suited to local conditions and cost little

36. The claim 'modern bought seeds and chemicals are always better than traditional methods' is wrong because:

(A) modern seeds never raise yields (B) traditional methods give no food at all

(C) chemicals are free and completely harmless

(D) high-yield seeds cost money, need much water and can damage soil, so many farmers blend old and new methods

37. 'Subsistence farming' means growing:

(A) mainly enough to feed one's own family, with little or nothing to sell

(B) huge amounts purely for export (C) flowers only, for decoration

(D) crops without any soil

38. 'Commercial farming' means growing crops mainly:

(A) only to feed one's own family (B) to sell in the market

(C) without ever harvesting them (D) only in ancient times

39. The claim 'all farming in India is basically the same' is wrong because farming:

(A) is identical on every farm in the country

(B) varies with soil, climate, season and whether it is subsistence or commercial, rain-fed or irrigated

(C) never changes with the season (D) uses exactly one crop everywhere

40. A farmer who grows just enough rice to feed her household, selling none, is practising:

(A) subsistence farming (B) commercial farming

(C) horticulture for export (D) the Green Revolution

41. Traditional farming differs from contemporary farming mainly in that traditional farming:

(A) always uses the most machinery and chemicals

(B) produces no food at all

(C) relies more on saved seeds, natural inputs and inherited wisdom

(D) was invented in the 1960s

42. The 'Green Revolution' of the 1960s-70s used:

(A) only saved traditional seeds and no chemicals

(B) only hand tools and no irrigation

(C) high-yielding seeds, irrigation, chemicals and machinery to boost food production

(D) barter instead of money

43. The greatest success of the Green Revolution was that it:

(A) made India self-sufficient in food (B) ended all farming in India

(C) removed the need for any water (D) made every farmer wealthy forever

44. The claim 'the Green Revolution was only a good thing' is wrong because, over time, it also:

(A) had no effects of any kind (B) reduced India's food supply

(C) impoverished the soil, depleted groundwater, polluted soil and water, and harmed health

(D) made all chemicals disappear

45. Scientists now seek more sustainable farming methods mainly because:

(A) the Green Revolution produced too little food

(B) chemicals were found to be completely harmless

(C) the Green Revolution's heavy chemical and water use harmed soil, water and health over time

(D) India banned all farming

46. Depleting groundwater through heavy irrigation is a problem because:

(A) it makes the soil richer every year (B) it has no effect on future farming

(C) it creates new rivers

(D) the water that crops and people depend on can run low for the future

47. The overall lesson of the Green Revolution is that boosting yields with chemicals can:

(A) bring only benefits with no costs (B) bring only costs with no benefits

(C) bring short-term gains but long-term costs to soil, water and health

(D) have no link to soil or water at all

48. 'Organic farming' is farming that:

(A) uses the maximum possible chemicals

(B) avoids chemical fertilisers and pesticides, using natural ones like compost, manure and neem

(C) grows crops without any soil (D) relies only on imported seeds

49. 'Sustainable farming' means farming that:

(A) uses up all resources as fast as possible(B) ignores the future entirely

(C) produces no food today

(D) meets today's needs without harming the soil, water or the ability to farm in future

50. Using neem as a natural pesticide instead of chemical sprays is an example of:

(A) the Green Revolution (B) commercial export farming

(C) organic farming (D) minting

51. Why might a farmer blend saved seeds and organic methods with some modern inputs?

(A) to gain good yields while protecting the soil and keeping costs down

(B) because chemicals alone never raise yields

(C) to make farming as harmful as possible

(D) because the law forbids any modern tools

52. 'Terrace farming' is:

(A) cutting a hillside into level steps so crops can be grown and rainwater held on steep slopes

(B) farming on flat desert sand only (C) growing crops in deep water with no soil

(D) selling crops in a market

53. 'Horticulture' is the cultivation of:

(A) only cereals like wheat and rice (B) fish in ponds

(C) fruits, vegetables and flowers (D) trees for timber only

54. The '-cide' in 'pesticide' means:

(A) 'garden' - a pesticide is a garden (B) 'killer' - a pesticide kills crop pests

(C) 'water' - a pesticide waters crops (D) 'seed' - a pesticide is a seed

55. The belief 'plants can only grow in soil' is wrong because:

(A) plants actually need no nutrients at all

(B) hydroponics lets plants grow in nutrient-rich water, with minerals given directly to the roots

(C) plants can only grow on bare rock (D) plants grow only in the desert

56. Hydroponics is especially useful for:

(A) urban farming and places with poor soil

(B) growing crops where there is no water at all(C) replacing the need for any nutrients

(D) farming only in ancient times

57. The chapter notes that, in rural India, most agricultural work is done by:

(A) only men (B) only machines

(C) only foreign workers (D) women

58. The fact that women do most farm operations means the 'typical farmer' in rural India is:

(A) always a man (B) never an Indian

(C) always a machine (D) more likely to be a woman than a man

59. Real challenges facing Indian farmers today include:

(A) too much land and no climate at all (B) having no crops to grow ever

(C) a complete absence of any difficulties

(D) shrinking landholdings, climate change and debt

60. A student says, 'The Green Revolution was purely good, and the typical Indian farmer is a man using only modern chemicals.' The best correction is:

(A) the Green Revolution had mixed effects, most rural farm work is done by women, and many farmers blend traditional and modern methods

(B) the Green Revolution had only benefits, and all farmers are men using chemicals

(C) farming in India never changed at all(D) women do no farm work in India

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 13: The Story of Indian Farming

Marking: **+4** correct, **−1** wrong, **0** unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	C	21	D	31	C	41	C	51	A
2	A	12	D	22	B	32	B	42	C	52	A
3	B	13	A	23	C	33	B	43	A	53	C
4	B	14	B	24	A	34	A	44	C	54	B
5	A	15	D	25	D	35	D	45	C	55	B
6	B	16	B	26	B	36	D	46	D	56	A
7	D	17	C	27	C	37	A	47	C	57	D
8	D	18	A	28	C	38	B	48	B	58	D
9	A	19	C	29	D	39	B	49	D	59	D
10	A	20	D	30	B	40	A	50	C	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) Agriculture is cultivating soil, growing crops and rearing animals (and broadly forestry, horticulture, fisheries and beekeeping). It is not trade, minting, or construction.

2. (A) Farming is called the backbone of the Indian economy. It is neither the smallest, newest, nor least important part.

3. (B) Broadly, agriculture includes forestry, horticulture, fisheries and beekeeping. Banking, minting and construction are not agriculture.

4. (B) Farming is among humankind's oldest occupations. It is not recent, rare, or useless.

5. (A) Rice grains from the Ganga Plain (7th-8th millennium BCE) show early cultivation. It was not the high Himalayas, the desert recently, or the ocean floor.

6. (B) Barley at Mehrgarh marks early farming. Hampi (a bazaar), Surat (textiles) and Imphal (the Ima Keithal market) are from other chapters.

7. (D) The Arthashastra and Krishi-Parashara recorded farming wisdom. The Aryabhatiya and Meghadutam are Gupta science and poetry, the Prashasti and Hathigumpha are royal inscriptions, and the Brihat Samhita is Varahamihira's encyclopedia.

8. (D) The Harappans were among India's early farmers. They did not invent paper money, lead the Green Revolution, or build malls.

9. (A) The long span shows farming as an ancient, continuous Indian tradition - not a recent invention, a foreign import, or an abandoned practice.

10. (A) The monsoon winds bring most of India's rainfall. Glacier melt, rivers and tides are not the main rain source.

11. (C) The southwest monsoon brings rain from June to September. October to December is the northeast monsoon; the other options are wrong.

12. (D) The northeast monsoon brings rain from October to December. June to September is the southwest monsoon; the others are wrong.

13. (A) A poor monsoon can damage harvests, especially where farms depend on rain. It is not harmless, never purely helpful, and does not change soil types.

14. (B) India's cropping seasons are kharif, rabi and zaid. The others name generic seasons, soil types, or irrigation methods.

15. (D) Kharif crops are monsoon crops sown with the southwest monsoon. Winter crops are rabi, short summer crops are zaid, and no crop grows with zero water.

16. (B) Rabi crops are winter crops of the cool season, harvested in spring. Monsoon-sown crops are kharif, short summer crops are zaid, and deserts are not the defining feature.

17. (C) Zaid crops are short summer crops grown between rabi and kharif. Monsoon crops are kharif, winter crops are rabi, and zaid crops are short, not multi-year.

18. (A) A monsoon-sown June crop is kharif. Rabi is winter-sown, zaid is short summer, and 'terrace' is a farming method, not a season.

19. (C) Kharif is the monsoon (hot, rainy) season, rabi the cool winter, and zaid the short summer between rabi and the next kharif. The other orders are wrong.

20. (D) Alluvial soil is fertile river-borne silt. It is not wind-blown desert sand, volcanic rock, or plastic.

21. (D) India has six major soil types. Two, twelve and fifty-one (the Shakti pithas) are wrong.

22. (B) Humus is dark, nutrient-rich organic matter from decomposed plants and animals, holding moisture. It is not a seed, a pesticide, or a canal.

23. (C) Humus enriches soil with nutrients and helps it hold moisture. It does not dry soil, harden it to rock, or kill plants.

24. (A) Different soils suit different crops, so farming varies by place. Soils are not identical, soil does matter, and many crops grow across India.

25. (D) Rain-fed farming relies on rainfall alone. Farms watered by canals, pumps or piped sources are irrigated, and seawater is not used.

26. (B) Irrigation is artificially supplying water to crops (canals, wells, pumps, drip, sprinkler). Relying only on rain is rain-fed farming, and the others are not irrigation.

27. (C) Irrigation supplies water independently of the monsoon's timing, a key advantage. It does not stop rainfall, work only in the rains, or remove the need for soil.

28. (C) A bund is a low embankment that retains water or prevents soil erosion. It is not a seed, a fertiliser, or a crop.

29. (D) Traditional water structures reveal long-standing skill in storing and managing water. Farmers clearly did think about water, did not depend on modern pumps, and farmed in varied climates.

30. (B) Crop rotation alternates different crops in a field to protect soil nutrients. It is not growing one crop endlessly, literally spinning the field, or importing crops.

31. (C) By alternating crops, rotation avoids draining one nutrient and helps replenish the soil. It does not strip all nutrients, create sand, or stop future growth.

32. (B) Repeating one crop drains a specific nutrient and weakens the soil, which rotation prevents. It does not enrich soil forever, make it immortal, or grow a forest.

33. (B) Protecting and maintaining soil health is soil conservation. Irrigation is watering, export is selling abroad, and minting is making coins.

34. (A) Seeds are either saved (traditional) or bought from companies. They are not army-only imports, printed, or metal.

35. (D) Saved seeds are handed down, locally adapted and cheap. They do not guarantee the highest yield, demand heavy chemicals, or vanish after one use.

36. (D) High-yield seeds and chemicals raise output but cost money, demand water and can harm soil, so farmers often blend traditional and modern methods. Modern seeds do raise yields, traditional methods do feed people, and chemicals are neither free nor harmless.

37. (A) Subsistence farming feeds the family with little surplus. Large export-only growing is commercial, flower-growing is horticulture, and soil-free growing is hydroponics.

38. (B) Commercial farming grows crops to sell. Feeding one's family is subsistence; crops are harvested; and it is not ancient-only.

39. (B) Indian farming varies enormously by soil, climate, season and type, so there is no single 'Indian farm'. It is not identical, season-blind, or single-crop.

40. (A) Growing only enough to feed the family is subsistence farming. Selling crops is commercial, export fruit and flower growing is horticulture, and the Green Revolution is a historical transformation.

41. (C) Traditional farming leans on saved seeds, natural inputs and inherited knowledge, while contemporary farming uses more machinery and chemicals. It is not the most chemical-heavy, food-less, or a 1960s invention.

42. (C) The Green Revolution combined high-yielding seeds, irrigation, chemicals and machinery to raise output. It was not chemical-free traditional farming, hand-tool-only, or about barter.

43. (A) The Green Revolution made India self-sufficient in food. It did not end farming, remove the need for water, or guarantee lasting wealth.

44. (C) The Green Revolution's record is mixed: it boosted food but also damaged soil, depleted groundwater, caused pollution and harmed health. It was not effect-free, did not cut food supply, and did not remove chemicals.

45. (C) The long-term harms of chemical- and water-intensive farming have driven the search for sustainable methods. The Green Revolution did not produce too little food, chemicals are not harmless, and farming was not banned.

46. (D) Over-pumping groundwater can leave too little for the future - a sustainability problem. It does not enrich soil, lack future effects, or create rivers.

47. (C) The Green Revolution shows that chemical-driven yield gains can carry serious long-term costs - a balanced, mixed verdict. It was neither all-benefit, all-cost, nor unrelated to soil and water.

48. (B) Organic farming avoids synthetic chemicals, using compost, manure and neem. It is not chemical-maximising, soil-free (that is hydroponics), or import-dependent.

49. (D) Sustainable farming (Latin sustinere, 'to maintain') meets present needs without wrecking future farming. It does not exhaust resources, ignore the future, or fail to feed people today.

50. (C) Using neem rather than chemical sprays is organic farming. It is not the chemical-heavy Green Revolution, export farming, or minting.

51. (A) Blending old and new aims for good yields with healthier soil and lower costs - a balanced, sustainable approach. Chemicals can raise yields, harm is not the goal, and modern tools are not banned.

52. (A) Terrace farming carves a hillside into steps to grow crops and hold water on slopes. It is not desert farming, soil-free water-growing, or selling crops.

53. (C) Horticulture (Latin hortus, 'garden') is growing fruits, vegetables and flowers. Cereals, fish-rearing and timber-only forestry are different branches.

54. (B) From Latin caedere ('to kill'), '-cide' means 'killer', so a pesticide kills pests. It does not mean garden, water, or seed.

55. (B) Hydroponics grows plants in nutrient-rich water without soil. Plants do need nutrients, are not limited to rock, and do not grow only in deserts.

56. (A) Hydroponics suits urban areas and poor-soil places, giving minerals directly in water. It still needs water and nutrients and is a modern method, not an ancient one.

57. (D) More than 75% of those working in agriculture in rural India are women, who do much of the sowing, harvesting and threshing. It is not men-only, machine-only, or foreigner-only.

58. (D) Since women do most farm work, the typical rural farmer is more likely a woman, correcting the 'farmer = man' idea.

59. (D) Today's farmers face shrinking landholdings, climate change and debt. They do not have endless land, no climate, no crops, or zero difficulties.

60. (A) The Green Revolution's record is mixed, women do most rural farm work, and farmers often blend old and new methods - correcting all three errors. The other options repeat the misconceptions.